



7 tips To Make You Better at **Problem Solving** in DS & Algo

Swipe



1. Understand The Question Thoroughly

Make sure to get a good understanding of problems. Ask yourself...

- 1. ? What datatype the input would be and how large is it?
- 2. ? What would be the extreme and edge cases that you'd need to cover?
- 3. ? How is the output expected and do you understand the test cases properly?

2. Dry Run your Code

Dry running your code is an essential skill for every engineer & will help you a lot during interviews.

You will be able to spot errors much quicker and solve them easier.

3. Identify Patterns Among The Problems You Solve

Try and learn famous approaches to solve problems → Sliding Windows, Two Pointers, Graph Traversals, Merging Intervals that are frequently used to solve a wide variety of problems.

4. Understand Time and Space Complexities

Every coding problem has to be optimised through its time & space complexities.

You need to understand how to improve your code from brute force to efficient methods.

5. Keep Track Of Your Mistakes

When practising a ton of questions, you will end up repeating a few mistakes.

Note them down and understand where your approach is going wrong and try not to make similar mistakes again.

6. Spaced Repetition

DSA is not about mugging the code or solutions but understanding the core approach behind it & mapping it to different problems.

Refer back to your solved problems after 3 days, 1 week or whatever works for you.

7. Timed Solving

Most of the time while practising you may spend a lot of time on particular questions but interviews will be time bound.

Start working on your approach to solve new questions in a timed manner.



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Rahul Verma


